



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Human rights

BEFORE

1948 The UN adopts the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

1965 The UN's International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination is adopted.

AFTER

1979 The UN adopts the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women.

1989 The UN's Convention on the Rights of the Child deals comprehensively with the rights of those under the age of 18.

1989 The Second Optional Protocol of the ICCPR aims to abolish the death penalty.

1992 The United States ratifies the ICCPR.

THE FOUNDATION OF FREEDOM, JUSTICE, AND PEACE

THE INTERNATIONAL COVENANT ON CIVIL AND POLITICAL RIGHTS (1966)

Any state signing up to the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (**ICCPR**) must implement **agreed-upon rights** ...

by passing
new laws
protecting
rights,

enforcing
existing laws
protecting
rights,

and providing
local remedies
for human rights
abuses.

Failure to implement rights means the state is not complying with the Covenant.

A victim of a **violation of the rights** in the ICCPR may take a case to the UN's **Human Rights Committee.**

The International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR) is one of the two big international treaties created by the United Nations (UN) in 1966—the other being the International Covenant on Economic, Social, and Cultural Rights (ICESCR)—that turned the 1948 Universal

Declaration of Human Rights into binding international law. These two treaties together make up the International Bill of Human Rights.

After the UN Commission on Human Rights drafted the ICCPR and opened it for signature in 1966, it came into force in 1976. Countries that sign up to it are